

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 237

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Knoxville Webb Spartans boys' basketball team upon winning the Division II-AA state tournament.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary group of lads is the Spartans boys' basketball team of Webb School of Knoxville, whose members have proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by winning the 2025 TSSAA Division II-AA state tournament; and

WHEREAS, after earning a bye in the first round, the Spartans bested Christian Brothers 44-35 in the quarterfinals to advance in their quest for the state championship; and

WHEREAS, playing in the Division II-AA state tournament at Tennessee Tech's Hooper Eblen Center, Knoxville Webb crushed Ensworth 58-40 in their semi-final match-up and then defeated Briarcrest 54-45 in the title game to bring home the Gold Ball trophy that signifies a state champion; and

WHEREAS, the Spartans relied heavily upon the athleticism, leadership, and determination of Division II-AA state tournament Most Valuable Player Cam Swearengen and Owen Lentz, who was named to the All-Tournament team; and

WHEREAS, in their eighteenth trip to the state tournament, Knoxville Webb claimed their second championship, having previously won it all in 2019 in their only previous title game appearance; and

WHEREAS, the Knoxville boys' basketball team combined with their female counterparts to demonstrate that two titles are "twice as nice" and celebrated the Lady Spartans 2025 Division II-AA state championship in equal measure with their own victory; and

WHEREAS, the following young men are proud to call themselves Spartans: Owen Lentz, Jaylen Pompey, Tahj Bowers, Cam Swearengen, Javon Dirl, Alex Leeth, Wilson Luton, Daran Taylor, Luke Neiss, Huston Torres, Schuyler Huck, and Shavar Young; and

WHEREAS, Knoxville Webb's superb performance would not have been possible without the stellar leadership of Head Coach Ricky Norris and assistant coaches Zach Gulmire, James Michel, Rashawn Rembert, and David Sanger and the unfailing support of the players' families, their fans, and their community; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Knoxville Webb boys' basketball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the perseverance, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young men not only made possible a championship season but also surely bode well for their future success; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the Knoxville Webb Spartans for their outstanding season on the hardwood; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the members and coaches of the Knoxville Webb Spartans boys' basketball team upon winning the Division II-AA state tournament, recognize them as state champions, and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.